

Figure 8.2 Sources of vitamin A

Functions of vitamin A:

- Vitamin A plays a significant role in the visual cycle (as a component of rhodopsin).
- Retinoic acid plays a key role in glycoprotein synthesis.
- It is essential for the normal structure and functions of epithelial tissues.
- Retionic acid inhibits the enzyme collagenase and thus prevents the breakdown of collagen.
- Retinoic acid is essential for sulfation of the mucopolysaccharides.
- It promotes fertility.
- It is needed for the formation of bone and teeth.
- β-carotene is an antioxidant and plays a role in trapping peroxy radicals in tissues.

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